

Patna Airport

INDIA'S AVIATION SECTOR

Ascending to New Heights of Growth and Connectivity

India's aviation industry is presently witnessing extraordinary growth, fueled by rising passenger demand and strong government backing through forward-thinking policies. Over the last decade, the sector has experienced a significant transformation, establishing India as a prominent player in the global aviation arena. By 2025, India has solidified its status to become the third-largest domestic aviation market.

This upward growth trend is expected to persist in the forthcoming years, with India's aviation sector ready for swift expansion over the next decade as well. The Indian government's dedication to the sector's advancement has been crucial to attain this achievement. A range of strategic measures, aimed at bolstering infrastructure, improving connectivity, and promoting a more competitive marketplace, have been enacted to facilitate this growth.



> **"In recent years, India's aviation sector has advanced at an unprecedented pace. Today, India stands among the fastest growing domestic aviation markets in the world."**
>
> **Shri Narendra Modi**
> Hon'ble Prime Minister

Expanding Infrastructure: A Fundamental Element of Growth

India's aviation infrastructure has experienced remarkable expansion. The count of operational airports in the nation has more than doubled, rising from 74 in the year 2014 to 164 at present. The government's objective of reaching 350 operational airports by 2047 further underscores the ambitious vision for this sector. This transformation presents a vital opportunity for aviation stakeholders to enhance their capabilities, anticipate future demands, and collaboratively tackle the challenges that come with rapid expansion. The Airports Authority of India (AAI), being the biggest Air Navigation Service Provider (ANSP) and largest airport operator in the country, has played a crucial role in facilitating this growth.

AAI is tasked with the development of new airports as well as the enhancement of existing infrastructure to meet India's escalating aviation needs. Additionally, AAI is improving air navigation services to boost operational efficiency and ensure safe and reliable air travel.

Apart from deploying a strong and skilled workforce to meet varying operational needs, AAI has also invested in training infrastructure, including three specialized Air Traffic Services Training Organizations namely Civil Aviation Training College (CATC) at Prayagraj, Hyderabad Training Centre (HTC) at Hyderabad and National Institute of Aviation Training and Management (NIATAM)at Gondia. Additionally, AAI established the Civil Aviation Research Organisation (CARO) in Hyderabad, driving innovation and research in air traffic control, navigation services, and airport operations. CARO plays a key role in creating a more efficient, future-ready aviation ecosystem, supporting India's Aatmanirbhar Bharat vision.

Regional Connectivity: Promoting Inclusivity and Economic Development

Launched in 2016, the Regional Connectivity Scheme (UDAN) has transformed India's aviation by revitalizing airstrips and providing air connectivity in underserved areas, improving access to remote locations and promoting socio-economic inclusion. The Airports Authority of India has been key in